Documentation Pages

WHO AM I

- Fourth-year student at the **University of Guelph** in the **BAH Culture and Technology Studies** (CTS) program with a minor in **Studio Art** (practically Fine Arts).
- Here's my Personal Blog
- The current objective is to create a video game for my capstone project for the CTS program. The project will investigate how AI can be integrated into game development to enhance creativity without undermining authorship, labour, or morality.

THE IDEA

An amateur detective mystery game set at a summer camp. The player starts uncovering the hidden cult within the camp by doing their job (maintaining the property) and interacting with NPCs.

- Kids at the camp are barely worth interacting with and can't be harmed.
    - E.g., "I hear it's chicken caesar wraps for lunch; my favourite!" "I'm late to Archery." "How long 'till the bathroom's clean?"
- Certain NPCs are really good at deflecting questions; others you shouldn't ask questions at all, lest you lose the game (get "asked to leave" or disposed of).
- Culty behaviours that're disguised as camp rituals: Flaming H, Candle ceremony (like a baptism), sing-along lunches, 'Service without recognition,' checking cottagers/outsiders for passes, fires (and the songs that go along with it), giant JESUS SAVES billboard on the highway into the camp
- If your dialogue is suspicious, you can get "caught," and all NPCs in the know chase you down, and if they touch you, you get sedated and ritualized.
    - Can only escape this fate by running successfully

IMPORTANT LINKS:

PROJECT LOG OLD INDEX WORKPLAN

[eventual link to host site]

[eventual link to game itself]

LINK TO FUNCTIONAL GAME .ZIP (Requires Godot to access)

GAME REPOSITORY

CHOOSING THE TOOLS:

There were a few options available for how to make this game that I must sift through to find what's best for my project:

- **Hard-coded from scratch**
    - CSS and HTML, Python, etc.
        - Would be good for Co-creation with AI if I were more skilled with coding.
- **AI Development tool**
    - Base44
        - Too AI-dominant to be considered co-creation in my eyes.
- **Other Programs/Engines**
    - Inform7
    - Godot
    - GameMaker
    - Unity
    - Unreal Engine

While I would love to learn more advanced industry-standard engines, like Unity or Unreal Engine, that would drastically change the scope of my project. However, it would be best for extrapolating my project's findings to a larger scale (AAA Studios). Therefore, I'm going to take a crack at **Godot**. It seems easier than Unreal Engine, but difficult enough to be a nice challenge. Since I'm looking to make a mystery game set in a Camp, here's the To Do list:

- Make a small outdoor environment
    - Grass, trees, paths?
- 2D game
- Create the main character
- Create different NPCs
- Create buildings like the ones at my old camp

LEARNING GODOT:

Godot Docs

I started my Godot journey with a free course in learning GDScript (Godot's language). It took about 2 hours for me, and helped to reacquaint myself with coding and get introduced to this new language. From there, I followed a tutorial for making Your First 2D Game by Godot. It took a while, but I can potentially adapt the practice game into a minigame for my project.

After that, I created a new project to start fresh. Using ChatGPT at first and eventually Claude, I had a structure (scenes and node trees) for my project and had a helpful "friend" (Claude) to walk me through everything I did not know as if it were a realtime Godot Docs or tutorial.

ASSETS USED:

https://cupnooble.itch.io/sprout-lands-asset-pack (All map features)

https://www.spriters-resource.com/pc_computer/stardewvalley/ (Base body in all directions)

https://devworm.itch.io/survival-game-godot-4-series-art (Human worker Red)

https://limezu.itch.io/moderninteriors/devlog/244045/free-version-overview-18042021-update (Oliver, Hannah, and Ryan NPCs)

Woody's animated character: https://runninblood.itch.io/16x16-top-down-character (a little short but does the trick)

AI USE DOCUMENTED:

After I finished the practice game, I went to ChatGPT for structuring the main game and taking the first step. I find that starting a creative work with AI is detrimental; however, it is less so than delaying it because of how daunting it seems. So, I went to ChatGPT.

Here is a link to the conversation with ChatGPT where I received help with the starting node-tree structure of my project, some early-day code that was later altered, and troubleshooting: https://chatgpt.com/share/69a7427f-212c-800e-a670-73b3f7dc7d0d.

Though the troubleshooting was not great with ChatGPT, and I was still having problems with the player's physics. So, I thought I would give Claude a try. I was blown away by how helpful it was: https://claude.ai/share/395a280d-0e10-4b3a-a2c6-407e0bda9075

After half a YouTube tutorial on making my NPC camper, and another way-too-brief video on how to have AI dialogue NPCs in a Godot game, I needed some help walking me through doing it myself. So, I started a new chat with the prompt "How do I use Eidolon AI and an OpenAI API key to make my Godot NPC character have tailored AI responses?" https://claude.ai/share/c908ff36-3347-4e61-8ca4-4910b6a612d5

During this chat, I also purchased an OpenAI API key. I added $20 worth of token funds, which might have been overkill.

The next conversation with Claude allowed me to successfully implement the following: An inventory system for when players collect clues. Two clues to the game the player can pick up and log. A help and controls menu accessible from the top left of the game window. A tally to the amount of clues the player can collect (eventually 5, though they weren't yet implemented). A minimap of the game with markers and a live indicator of where the player is as they move around. Updating the changes I made to the camper NPC character sheet to the Eidolon Client.

Here's the link to the full conversation:
https://claude.ai/share/4cd9c11e-aecd-4d70-a71f-23ce7740d526

- https://claude.ai/share/44f4d17a-49c0-46f3-86f2-e3b534911db8 (NPC improvements; temporary character sheets, updated the Eidolon Client, finding free asset NPC animated sprites. Help with bathroom scene transitions, making a title screen, updating game window size to be larger, then had troubleshooting the issues that caused, and finally setting up a GitHub repository for the game.

Eidolon AI Setup:

For anyone who may use Eidolon like I have, here's the most significant terminal commands I used. Please don't use any of my personal information you may gleam from this insight into my terminal.

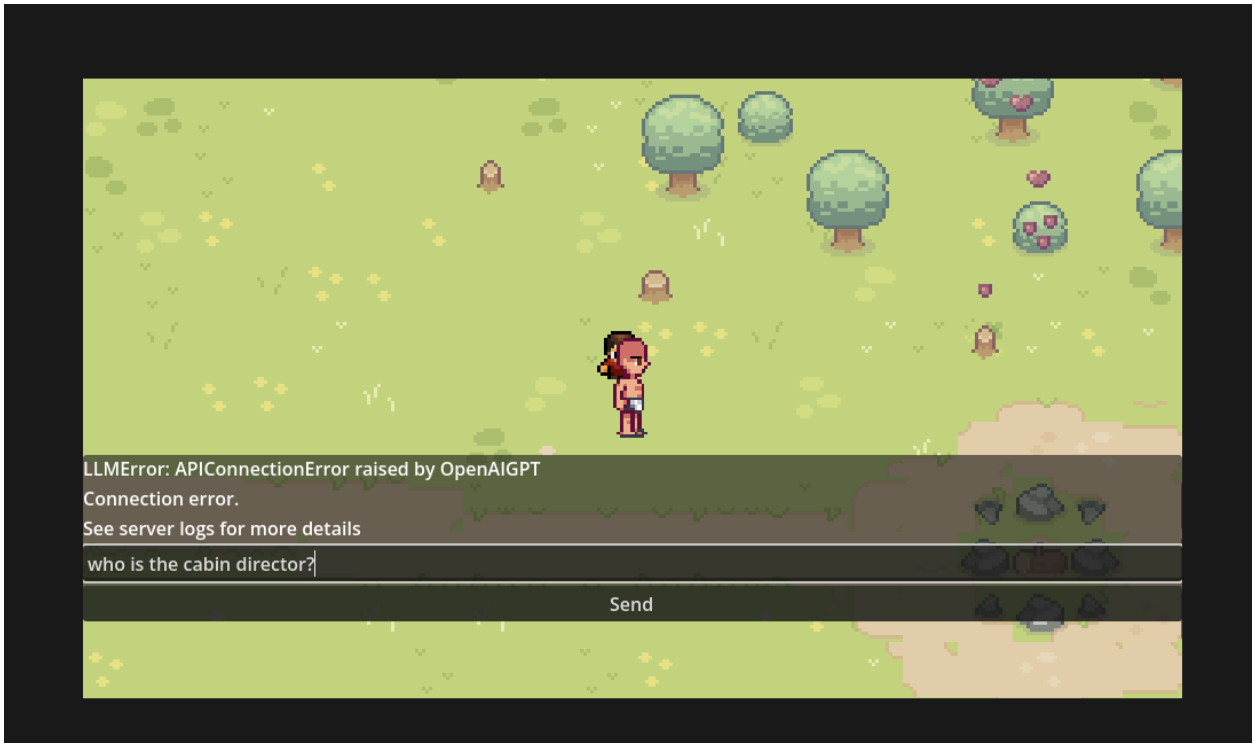
```
(base) iain@mecano desktop % cd my-npc-server
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % touch npc_agent.yaml
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % cd
(base) iain@mecano ~ % cd desktop
(base) iain@mecano desktop % cd my-npc-server
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % li
zsh: command not found: li
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % ls
resources
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % cd resources
(base) iain@mecano resources % ls
camperNPC.yaml
(base) iain@mecano resources % cd
(base) iain@mecano ~ % ls -R /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server
resources

/Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources:
camperNPC.yaml
(base) iain@mecano ~ % cd /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server
eidolon-server --resources /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources
usage: eidolon-server [-h] [-p PORT] [-r] [--debug] [-m MACHINE] [--record]
                      [--disable-metrics DISABLE_METRICS]
                      [--fail-on-bad-agent FAIL_ON_BAD_AGENT]
                      [--dotenv DOTENV] [--dotenv-override] [--watch WATCH]
                      yaml_path [yaml_path ...]
eidolon-server: error: unrecognized arguments: --resources
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % cd
(base) iain@mecano ~ % eidolon-server /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources/camperNPC.y
aml
INFO:     Started server process [69142]
```

(base) iain@mecano ~ % cd agent-machine
(base) iain@mecano agent-machine % cp /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources/camperNPC.yaml resources/
(base) iain@mecano agent-machine % make docker-serve

In every script file, I comment that Claude had written most–if not all–of the code, and I would link the Claude conversation that led to that code. Those links can be seen at the top of each script.

Significant errors encountered with the LLM:



PLAYER'S BACKSTORY PROMPT GIVEN TO CLAUDE:

"You were a camper for a few years but last year you came home missing some things (particularly one work boot, "How does someone lose 1 boot?"), having a vague memory of the last few weeks you were there, and a note to yourself in your journal saying "there's something going on here, I should have a look around..." But, strangely, feeling overall good towards camp despite all that and wanting to come back. With a year to reflect on how odd it was, you're coming back this year as a second year property staff with a purpose: get to the bottom of what's going on here."